Armor and Acquisitions

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Rating:
General Audiences

Archive Warning:
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F/F

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationship:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Angella & Glimmer (She-Ra), Perfuma/Scorpia (She-Ra), Bow/Glimmer (She-Ra)

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Additional Tags:
Human Catra (She-Ra), Human Scorpia (She-Ra), POV Glimmer (She-Ra), Glimmer-centric (She-Ra), Good Parent Angella (She-Ra), Oblivious Adora (She-Ra), Oblivious Catra (She-Ra), Alternate Universe - Modern with Magic, Alternate Universe - Superheroes/Superpowers, Superheroes, Useless Lesbians, Secret Identity, Secret Identity Fail, First Dates, Miscommunication, Glimmer is a Good Friend (She-Ra), no beta we die like men

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by ResFlower

Summary

"The other day , Catra said that she went out with a friend to see a movie. Then, Adora said she had seen that same movie on the same day!And they shrugged it of f like some coincidence! It’s what they do every time.”Glimmer starts to mutter almost to herself.

"They have to be toying with me at this point, there is no other reasonable explanation.”Angella lets out a delicate snort in amusement.

"Not everything is about you darling.”Angella then narrows her gaze, eyes serious.

"Glimmer , Ive told you time and again the Alliance only works based on trust. You cannot break the confidence of the heroes that sacrifice their life and limb for a spot of gossip."Angella leans back in her chair now, giving Glimmer a conspiring look.

"Although I will say its a wonder if they havent figured it out yet."Glimmer points at her mother accusingly .

"See mom!Y ou want to know too!"

OR

Glimmer must find out if Adora and Catra know that they are friends and also superheroes, if only for her peace of mind. She doesnt find the peace she is looking for . Superhero AU.

Notes

My Beta is on vacation so any mistakes or mishaps are my own! Please enjoy!

See the end of the work for more notes

Glimmer is pacing in Angella's home of fice. It could barely be categorized as a home of fice really, given its inordinate size. In the days of the old Alliance, it is rumored that over fifteen heroes met in that very office when trouble was afoot. Now, it is Glimmer's runway.

She still has things to do for the Alliance meeting later today, but she also needs to talk to someone, and her mom is the only person who knows how to head the Alliance. Angella has been in this position before. Glimmer tugs at her hair. Angella watches Glimmer's pacing with an amused smile.

"I just dont know if they know and it's driving me crazy mom!" Angella leans forward in her large office chair, one manicured fingernail drawing lazy circles on her wooden desk. She waits. Glimmer keeps ranting.

"They have to suspect something right? They booked a vacation together! They are constantly busy on the same days!" Glimmer lists off. "It' s been five years! No two people can be that oblivious!"

"Y ou'd be surprised at how unobservant people can be when they arent expecting to see something," Angella says as she rifles through her papers.

"For example, Catra was working on a project for city hall, and she met me, as my true self, to discuss the parameters. She and I had dozens of meetings when I was the Director . She didnt bat an eyelash, not an iota of recognition." Angella gestures towards herself, bringing attention to her tall stature and recognizable pink and purple hair.

"How did she see me and not put two and two together? Because she simply wasnt looking for it. I mean honestly , none of our disguises are particularly brilliant. We get by because we hide in plain sight." Glimmer stares at her mother for a moment, then continues her pacing.

"I see your point, but this is on another level. The other day , Catra said that she went out with a friend to see a movie. Then, Adora said she had seen that same movie on the same day!And they shrugged it off like some coincidence!It' s what they do every time."Glimmer starts to mutter almost to herself.

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"Although I will say it's a wonder if they haven't figured it out yet." Glimmer points at her mother accusingly.

"See mom!Y ou want to know too!"Angella rolls her eyes.

"I've been retired as the Director for quite some time now , I don't have obligations to remain impartial in Alliance matters anymore." Angella delivers her most knowing signature mom stare.

"Unlike someone else I know , who actively holds both these ladies' identities in trust."Glimmer 's shoulders slump. She looks out one of the large windows at Bright Moon's skyline in the distance.

"I know , I know."Glimmer sighs and gets closer to Angella.

"I've also felt a lot of pressure from the push both in the media and within the Alliance itself to do away with secret identities. That's what's really stressing me out."Glimmer finally admits. Angella's eyes soften.

"I know this is a new generation and some heroes want to be known and seen for who they are. I think that's wonderful. We have evolved from when heroes were forced into the shadows. But Glimmer, I heed you to be mindful of personal choice. You shouldn't force heroes to leave their masks behind if it's not what they want." Glimmer looks at her mom, her words weighing heavy over them both.

"I know mom. Thank you." She steps behind her mother's chair gives her shoulders a squeeze. Angella smiles kindly. She stands and pulls Glimmer into a hug.

"I'm proud of you. Good luck with your Alliance meeting this afternoon, little love."

The Alliance meeting room is grand in a way Angella's large home office isn't, for obvious reasons. There are paintings of past heroes, rare gifts from visiting dignitaries, and a whole department dedicated to preserving the history and security of the building. Glimmer teleports in, power walking as inconspicuously as possible to her seat.

She is running late but she isn't the last hero to make it to the meeting, so she considers it a victory. She finds her seat at the head of the Alliance table. She still gets chills when she sits in what used to be her mother's chair.

She thinks most everyone is present, except for Double Trouble who is perpetually late. Glimmer looks around the table, her gaze stops short on She-ra. Glimmer tilts her head and squints her eyes, taking in She-ra's appearance.

She-ra's hair is defying gravity, moving lazily about her head almost in a halo. Huh. That's new. Glimmer isn't the only one that notices.

"Hey, are you moonlighting as Shadow's apprentice? Your hair is really weird." Wildcat snarks, eyeing the way She-ra's hair bobs and

ebbs with suspicion. She-ra looks totally unbothered by the comparison.

"I'm just feeling .floaty today is all." She-ra's eyes also seemed to have a dim glow which was also unusual. Typically, her eyes didn't glow unless she was tapping deep into her powers.

"Floaty? Since when? You are always uptight when-" It looks like a light bulb goes off over Wildcat's head.

"Did you take my advice? Is that what has you *floaty*." Wildcat's voice singsongs as it drips with smugness. It's impressive how her voice does both, really. She-ra turns red and tosses a crumpled page of her notebook in Wildcat's direction.

"I thought you said we weren't going to talk about our love lives"? She counters in a hissed whisper. It's a wasted effort. The rest of the seated heroes glance at them curiously. They might be do-gooders, but the Alliance is full of gossip.

Glimmer watches the back and forth. For what feels like the millionth time since She-ra joined the Alliance, she wonders if Wildcat and She-ra know they are friends in their civilian lives.

Glimmer spots Double Trouble leisurely walk in and drop into their seat, putting their feet up on the table and crossing them. Before Wildcat can embarrass She-ra further with whatever they are on about, Glimmer calls the meeting to order.

"First I'd like a report from Arrow and Entrapta, on the tech improvements since Entrapta joined our team." Entrapta looks like she could vibrate through time as she looks over her notes. She and Arrow are sitting with a mix of tech, tablets, notes, and maps strewn between them.

"Isn't it a little too trusting to be giving this information to a brand-new member who was like just conspiring with Hordak"? Mermista states drolly.

"Entrapta is incredibly qualified to update our tech because she designed Hordak's tech. Besides, Scorpia and Wildcat both vouched for her when she defected two weeks ago. I trust their judgment." Glimmer's tone brokers no room for argument.

Glimmer knows very few details of when Wildcat joined the Alliance, but the details she does know told her that Catra would never trust someone who worked under Shadow or Hordak unless she has a great reason. Mermista rolls her eyes but doesn't press further. Arrow clears his throat.

"Well, we have been working on different prototypes for some of the techs we already use as well as new tech. We only have a few things done, everything else is back in the lab." Arrow continues, looking down at his notes, squinting as he reads.

"So for Wildcat, we have enhanced the design of your tech claws." Arrow places thin bracelets in front of Wildcat, who eyes them with interest.

She places the bracelets on her wrist and when she flicks them, long daggers that look like claws protrude across her hand. With another flick, the bracelets look harmless again. Wildcat goes through the motions a few times, each time faster than the last.

"These should be easier to maneuver in a fight than your old ones, they are also lighter and thinner without compromising the strength of the daggers. Try them out and let us know if they need adjusting."

"Yeah, no problem." Wildcat smirks. Glimmer expects she will need to order extra practice dummies for the Alliance gym this month.

"The suit too Arrow!" Entrapta pipes in, looking up from her screen for a fraction. Arrow taps his forehead as if he forgot something.

"Thanks, Trapt! We also increased the flame resistance on your suit so you don't singe it when you light your whip on fire." Wildcat nods, less enthused by the suit than in the new claws.

"Next up is DT! We are working on a suit that will be able to shapeshift with you. It isn't fully functional yet, we will need you to stop by the lab to help us out this week." Double Trouble puts one of their hands upon their forehead, as if pained.

"I'm willing to sacrifice, not everyone can have it as easy as kitten here." Catra casually flips off Double Trouble with her tech claws. Entrapta does not notice.

"It's truly fascinating how your powers work! I used an invisibility suit as the base. I really think I can get it to become any fabric once you are wearing it! I need more experiments to be sure though!" Entrapta sounds gleeful. Arrow clears his throat again. He shifts his gaze to Seahawk.

"Seahawk, we have been improving on some of your grenades making them both more stable and explosive." Seahawk cheers at that. Arrow shoots him a glare.

"We have also been increasing the flame resistance of your glider ship to avoid any accidental fires." Seahawk whimpers at that. Arrow ignores him, continuing down the list.

"For Scorpia, we thought you might be interested in a gauntlet that could concentrate the electricity you shoot into like an energy ball." Scorpia furrows her brow and bites her lower lip hesitantly.

"That might be cool, but I want to make sure I get how it works, zapping someone on accident is no fun." Arrow hums in understanding.

"Okay, we will do some work and check back in." Arrow jots down some notes.

"Mermista, I know you don't usually use tech, but we had an idea for a gauntlet like Scorpia's. It would let you increase the pressure of the water you move and generate, almost like a pressure hose. What do

you think?" Mermista tries to hide her smile behind her hand. She glances at Entrapta.

"I guess her tech is pretty cool. She can stay ." Entrapta cheers, likely excited at the idea of making more gauntlets. Arrow then eyed Perfuma.

"I know you don't love using tech but I thought this might suit you. I know you have difficulty reaching plants when we are in more urban portions of Bright Moon-" Perfuma wilts at the reminder .

"How can a business district not have one tree! One!" Perfuma looks genuinely disturbed.

"-so, I thought a bot that could drill into the concrete and get you in contact with the dirt." Perfuma's eyes gleam at the prospect, but Glimmer interrupts.

"W e are going to have to run that by legal before you can build a prototype, that sounds like intentional property damage." Arrow , Entrapta, and Perfuma all lose their looks of excitement.

"Or the reclaiming of green space the people of Bright Moon deserve," Perfuma mutters petulantly . Arrow, ever the peacemaker, hurries on.

"Frosta, we thought you might benefit from an upgrade on your ice sword. If you give it to us we can figure a way to toggle it between different weapons. Like a hammer, for example." Frosta grins and bangs on the table.

"Hell yes! Ice hammer!" Arrow shoots Frosta a friendly wink.

"Shimmer , we have a new scepter for you. Lightweight and it should project your magic farther . We don't want to get your hopes up, but we think it might let you teleport someone from a distance. Try on me." Arrow gives her a gentle smile.

Glimmer feels the excitement boiling under her skin as Arrow hands her the scepter. Glimmer takes a few steps back and focuses on Arrow. Suddenly he is right in front of her, where she envisioned him. His eyes look so warm from this close. Glimmer hasn't noticed that before.

"Fascinating! I wonder what range it has!" Entrapta continues to ramble as she types furiously on her tablet. Arrow goes back to his seat.

"And last but not least I've been working on my arrows obviously, and Entrapta developed some bots for when she is cleared to go on missions!" Arrow conveys excitedly. Glimmer could tell that he really loves helping. It makes Glimmer's chest warm.

Arrow then stares at She-ra timidly. Glimmer winces, knowing exactly what he is going to ask.

"She-ra, you know, we could also do something for your First One's sword if you let us look at it." Arrow finishes with a nervous laugh. Everyone tenses, waiting for an explosive response. The last time Arrow floated the idea that he study She-ra's sword, Glimmer had to make extensive repairs to the meeting room.

She-ra doesn't look up from her notebook as she hums "No thanks!" and continues to doodle. Arrow shoots Glimmer a puzzled look and Glimmer shrugs. She certainly doesn't know why She-ra looks like she just came back from a spa week. The personality transplant is mind-boggling.

"Thanks for the report- Arrow, Entrapta. We look forward to using our new tools to protect Bright Moon." Arrow gives Glimmer a nod in recognition and relaxes into his chair, while Entrapta continues to type notes into her tablet, murmuring to herself under her breath.

The meeting continues. Glimmer runs through the more mundane parts of being superheroes: malpractice insurance premiums, defending against lawsuits for property damage, dry cleaning bills.

Glimmer eyes the table tentatively as she raises the final issue she wants to address.

"Our most pressing order of business and why I called a formal meeting with all ten of us is because we are facing many questions regarding the Alliance's stance on having an alter ego. I would like for us to make a public statement on our stance."The atmosphere immediately tenses.

"Does anyone want to speak for doing away with alter egos"? Glimmer asks. Perfuma motions to speak first.

"I was one of the first heroes that decided to forgo my alter ego, Golden Vine, and I would like to speak to that decision. I felt that keeping this part of myself a secret inhibited my aura-"Perfuma pointedly ignores the small snorts from Frosta and Wildcat at that word, "and I found it suf focating, having to put away a piece of myself."Perfuma' s eyes scan across the table.

"I know it is a risk, that it could very well make me a target, but it was the right decision for me. I would like to continue to be proud of who I am and not hide behind another name."Scorpia reaches out and squeezes Perfuma's hand, their chairs extremely close.

"I agree with Fuma. I like not having to lie or remember who I told what, I just am me. But I think everyone should have a choice. I know some heroes-"Scorpia's eyes flash to a very tense Wildcat-"don't want to and that's okay ."Seahawk pipes in.

"I do not hide my name or my V isage for I am Seahawk and I'm proud of it!"He flexes his bicep and strikes a pose, one foot on the table. Mermista swipes at his foot and he falls over.

"W ait,"She-ra's brow furrows, "your actual name is Seahawk"? Mermista groans.

"Seahawk you weren't supposed to tell anyone that is your actual name!"Mermista mutters under her breath, "this is embarrassing."

She clears her throat.

"Yeah, superhero names are a lot of effort. Im not about that. I already save everyone, the least they can do is not make me put ridiculous cosplaying energy into it."Mermista rolls her eyes.

Everyone eyes Entrapta, the last of the heroes that doesnt have an alter ego.

She doesnt realize until Wildcat whispers a short, "Hey Trapta, want to talk about why you dont have a superhero name?"Entrapta perks up.

"Well!Seems pointless, the data is out there for those who look. And it seems confusing."Entrapta goes back to tinkering with a small bot that Glimmer isnt sure was there earlier . Glimmer continues the discussion as the first masked hero to speak up.

"I keep my alter ego mostly because it feels traditional. Im not particularly attached either way."Really , Glimmer thinks, it is more to protect her mother's identity as the Director now that she works in City Hall. She doesnt say that though. Arrow leans back in his chair .

"Honestly , Im not big on having my identity a secret either but I worry about protecting my loved ones."Glimmer knew that Arrow has a ridiculous number of brothers so she could understand that. She-ra agrees with Arrow.

"I have people in my life I care about, people who might not be able to protect themselves from someone like Hordak, or Shadow, or Prime. I dont want anyone to get hurt because of who I am."She-ra's gaze goes distant as a troubled look passes over her features, her hair stops levitating for a moment.

"College would be such a pain if everyone knew I was in the Alliance. I dont want to be treated differently."Frosta adds in.

Double Trouble lazily shrugs and breezily says, "I do it for the drama, darling."Wildcat snorts loudly at Double T rouble's blasé commentary. All eyes are on her now. She tenses.

"Sometimes it's ok to keep things for yourself. I love being in the Alliance and I love helping people. I don't want it to affect how people see me outside of it. I don't want everyone to know everything about me."Wildcat grabs her own arm as if to make herself smaller .

"I'm proud of a lot of it-"Wildcat takes a deep breath "- but I also have a lot of shame associated with Wildcat. I don't want to carry it home."Glimmer looks at everyone and thinks back to her mother's words that morning.

"I think we could all agree that the policy should be based around personal choice?"There were murmurs of approval throughout.

"Okay . Ill put out a statement saying that each hero decides how they present themselves but to still direct all interview requests and communications through the Alliance?Who is in favor?"Nine hands shoot up at once. Scorpia nudges Entrapta, who raises her hand too. Glimmer feels relief.

"Okay great!Last query , from me at least. I need a few people for a mission on Friday night, we want to find out how Hordak got a hold of Wildcat and She-ra's Alliance phone number . We are doing some recon."Glimmer then directs her words at the two aforementioned heroes.

"Given that, it's about your privacy , would either of you be interested in coming?"They are both still in their seats, identical looks of panic on their faces.

"I absolutely cannot go on a mission this Friday ."Wildcat quickly spits out.

"Don't call me unless Bright Moon is about to be a pile of rubble, I already missed out on my vacation Im not missing-"Wildcat losses

steam, stutters for a second then recovers "-my plans. Yeah. Plans." She gives a definitive nod.

Glimmer raises her eyebrow but shrugs, that's why the Alliance has so many heroes after all.

"She-ra?" She-ra's hair falls limp and her face goes pale. Her eyes stop glowing and she looks down at the table.

"Um, I can't Friday either ." Glimmer feels her eyes bug out of her head.

"Are you alright?" She-ra has never turned down a mission for any reason whatsoever. She-ra coughs and looks away.

"I mean yeah, I just have something to do. It's personal. Real important. To me. Yeah." She laughs nervously as she rubs her neck.

"Well, I don't have any mysterious Friday night plans. Quiet unfortunate for me, but lucky for you! I love sneaking about, so I'm available." Double Trouble gives Wildcat and She-ra curious stares. Wildcat sneers back. She-ra refuses to look up from her notebook, embarrassed from the attention.

"Okay so me, DT , and could I get a third?" Glimmer needles. Arrow immediately raises his hand.

"I can go! I mean, it sounds like you could use some tech support so I'm happy to go with you- I mean support the mission whenever ." Glimmer feels warm all over at the thought of spending Friday with Arrow. Bow.

"That's great. I mean that we have it all figured out. If no one has any other business I adjourn this meeting." All at once, quiet talk starts up as everyone gets ready to disperse.

Glimmer always exits last to clear out the meeting room of stragglers and carry out proper security protocols. She can't help it if some people speak loudly as they leave.

She spots Wildcat bumping into She-ra.

"So, you did it?" Wildcat asks curiously. She-ra's voice is delighted as she responds.

"No, um, actually she asked me out. She beat me to it." She-ra's voice quiets as she says, "I'm not sure I would have had the courage to do it, but I'm glad she did."

Glimmer is actively, unashamedly, eavesdropping at this point.

"Well, *I* actually followed your advice and scored a date for this Friday, so this is me thanking you." Although Wildcat's voice is suave there is an undercurrent of excitement that could not be faked. She-ra glances at Wildcat.

"That's great! I'm proud of you, I know that couldn't have been easy." Wildcat punches She-ra's shoulder.

"Now don't go soft on me, She-ra." She-ra giggles and shoves Wildcat with a little more force than necessary, but Wildcat drops into a roll and pops back up unharmed.

"Sorry! Sometimes I don't know my own strength!" Wildcat smirks.

"Please as if you could even take me-" the words became inaudible once they finally leave the room.

Glimmer tries to piece together what is happening from the snippets she overheard. Seems like She-ra gave Wildcat advice for Catra to ask a woman out, now Catra had a date. Wildcat advised She-ra to pursue a woman as well, but Adora was asked out by the woman before she had a chance-

Glimmer freezes as the puzzle pieces come together.

Oh.

Oh.

What a mess. Glimmer idly wonders how two of the most capable women she knows could be so useless. She pulls up her phone and texts Angella. She is going to need another venting session with her mother.

End Notes

I hope y'all enjoyed this interlude!

What made me write a Glimmer POV was mostly because she is dying inside and that's always fun, but I also wanted to take the opportunity to do a little bit more world-building and introduce all the Alliance members.

Next week, the one-shot will be Adora's POV. Maybe she will take a chance and tell Catra about She-ra? Maybe?

Please drop by the archive and comment to let the author know if you enjoyed their work!